Iran

Journal of the British Institute of Persian Studies

ISSN: 0578-6967 (Print) 2396-9202 (Online) Journal homepage: https://www.tandfonline.com/loi/rirn20

# Burials and Memorials in Persia: Further Notes and Photographs

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**To cite this article:** Sir Denis Wright (Former President) (2001) Burials and Memorials in Persia: Further Notes and Photographs, Iran, 39:1, 293-298

**To link to this article:** https://doi.org/10.1080/05786967.2001.11834395

Published online: 23 Mar 2017.

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# BURIALS AND MEMORIALS IN PERSIA: FURTHER NOTES AND PHOTOGRAPHS

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*Former President of the British Institute of Persian Studies*

The material given below contains additions to my previous articles on burials and memorials of the British in Persia in *Iran* XXXVI (1998), pp. 165–73 and XXXVII (1999), pp. 173–74. I am deeply grateful to H.M. Ambassador Nick Browne and his wife Diana for the Isfahan photographs, taken in March 1999; and to Miss Joan Masters for those of Bushire, taken in February 2000, except for the photograph of the grave of Commandant A.Th. Sterzel, for which I am grateful to Lady (Susan) Elliott.

## ISFAHAN

### *The New Julfa Cemetery (Armenian)*

The graves of William Bell, d. 1624, and Edward Paget, d. 1703,[1] are the oldest known British graves in Persia. Their Latin inscriptions, recorded in full by Sir Frederick G. Goldsmid in his *Travels and Telegraph* (London, 1874), p. 562, remain legible. (Figs. 1–5.).

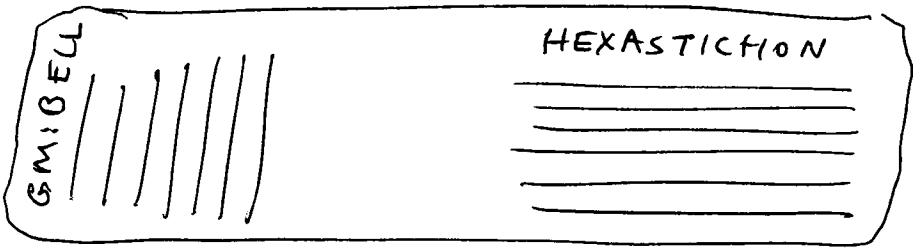


*Fig. 1. Diagram showing position of Bell gravestone (left-hand side) in relation to hexastichon.*

*Fig. 2. New Julfa Cemetery, Isfahan. William Bell's grave, headstone.*

*Fig. 3. New Julfa Cemetery, Isfahan. William Bell's gravestone. The hexastich (see Fig. 1) is set at right angles to the main inscription.*

*Fig. 4. New Julfa Cemetery, Isfahan. Edward Paget's gravestone, left-hand side.*

*Fig. 5. New Julfa Cemetery, Isfahan. Edward Paget's gravestone, right-hand side.*

*Fig. 6. St. George's Church (Armenian), Bushire. St. George's Church after war damage.*

*Fig. 7. St. George's Church (Armenian), Bushire. W.J. Bird.*

*Fig. 8. St. George's Church (Armenian), Bushire. Caroline Hayward.*

*Fig. 9. St. George's Church (Armenian), Bushire. Haick Goolzad.*

*Fig. 10. St. George's Church (Armenian), Bushire. Tigran J. Malcolm.*

*Fig. 11. St. George's Church (Armenian), Bushire. Commandant A.Th. Sterzel.*

## BUSHIRE

### *St. George's Church (Armenian)*

Both the church and adjoining cemetery were badly damaged during the Iran-Iraq War of the 1980s, and many of the memorials recorded in my 1998 article[2] have now gone; the five listed below are all that appear to have survived. Those of Haick Goolzad and Tigran Malcolm were not recorded in my earlier article, nor was that of the German A.Th. Sterzel.

W.J. Bird, d. 14.10.1890.[3]
Mrs Caroline Hayward, d. 19.10.1905.[4]
Haick Goolzad, b. 25.4.1875, d. 6.3.1941.
Tigran J. Malcolm, b. 1.3.1843, d. 4.5.1920.
Commandant A.Th. Sterzel, b. 25.6.1861 at Bautzen, Saxony, d. 16.9.1896 (Figs. 6–11).

The Goolzad and Malcolm headstones, inscribed in both English and Armenian, indicate that the deceased were members of the Bushire Armenian community and probably enjoyed British Protected Person status. Commandant Sterzel was captain of the 600-ton *Persepolis*, the Persian Navy's very first steamship, built at Bremerhaven in 1884; when Curzon inspected her at Lingeh in 1889 she had a crew of forty Persian and Arabs and four German officers.[5]

## RAYSHAHR (RESHIRE)

### *The old British Cemetery*[6]

This was abandoned in 1963 and remains in a sorry condition (Fig. 12). The ruined headstone of Ernest H. Tayson's grave was photographed by Paul Gotch in 1963:

Ernest H. Tayson, d. Bushire 3.4.1906 aged 26. Leading Seaman on H.M.S. *Hermes* (Fig. 13).

*Fig. 12. View of the abandoned cemetery.*

*Fig. 13. Ernest H. Tayson.*

*Notes*

1 See *Iran* XXXVI (1998), pp. 165–66.
2 *Ibid.*, p. 167.
3 *Ibid.*
4 *Ibid.*
5 The Hon. G.N. Curzon, *Persia and the Persian Question* (London, 1892), vol. II, pp. 394–96.
6 See *Iran* XXXVI (1998), pp. 167–68, and XXXVII (1999), p. 173.